

Lesson 20: Advanced Publishing and Sharing in Power BI

1. How does Power BI handle large datasets in the Online Service, and what is the role of Premium Capacity in this?

Power BI Online Service handles large datasets using Premium Capacity, which provides dedicated cloud resources for storage and performance. Premium allows larger dataset sizes, faster refresh rates, and improved performance. Without Premium, datasets are limited to 1 GB in shared capacity.

2. What are the differences between Import mode, DirectQuery, and Live Connection in Power BI Service?

Import Mode stores data in Power BI for fast performance but requires refreshes. DirectQuery sends queries to the data source in real-time, offering up-to-date data but slower performance. Live Connection connects directly to Analysis Services or existing datasets, suitable for enterprise models.

3. Explain deployment pipelines in Power BI Online. What stages do they include?

Deployment pipelines manage report promotion from development to production with three stages: Development (build and test), Test (validate and review), and Production (final release). Pipelines automate version control and maintain consistency.

4. How can Power BI Service integrate with Microsoft Teams or SharePoint for collaboration?

Power BI integrates with Teams and SharePoint for teamwork. In Teams, reports can be added as tabs or shared via chat. In SharePoint, reports can be embedded in pages using the Power BI web part.

5. What is the XMLA endpoint in Premium and how does it benefit developers or enterprise BI teams?

The XMLA endpoint allows developers to access and manage datasets programmatically using tools like SSMS or Tabular Editor. It enables automation, advanced scripting, and enterprise-scale BI management.

6. Describe how usage metrics and audit logs work in Power BI Service.

Usage metrics track report and dashboard interactions, showing user engagement. Audit logs, available via Microsoft 365 admin, record user activities such as sharing or publishing, ensuring governance and compliance.

7. How do you manage workspace access and permissions for different users?

Workspace access is managed with roles: Admin (full control), Member (edit and publish), Contributor (add and modify content), and Viewer (view-only). Permissions are adjusted in workspace settings.

8. How can data governance be enforced in Power BI Service?

Governance is enforced through Row-Level Security, sensitivity labels, audit logs, and certified datasets. These features ensure data security, compliance, and quality across reports.

9. What are the limitations of Row-Level Security when using DirectQuery or Live Connection?

RLS applies in DirectQuery and Live Connection but can reduce performance because filters are applied at the source in real time. In Live Connection, RLS must be configured in the data model, not in Power BI Service.

10. Explain how you can refresh a dataset via Power Automate or REST API.

In Power Automate, use the 'Refresh a dataset' action to automate refreshes on schedule or trigger. The REST API endpoint `/datasets/{datasetId}/refreshes` can also be called to refresh datasets programmatically for integration or automation.